

TOPIC 3: NIGERIAN CONSTITUTION (1999)

1. Basic Provisions

The 1999 Constitution (as amended) establishes Nigeria as a federation, defines the powers of the federal, state and local governments, sets out the structure of the executive, legislature and judiciary, and guarantees fundamental rights. It is the supreme law; other laws must conform to it.

2. Fundamental Objectives and Directive Principles

Chapter II sets out fundamental objectives and directive principles of state policy – goals for government in areas such as democracy, social justice, education, health and the economy. They guide policy even where they are not always directly enforceable in court like Chapter IV rights.

3. Importance for Citizens

Knowing the constitution helps citizens claim their rights, understand government limits and participate intelligently in public life.

4. Summary

The 1999 Constitution organises the Nigerian state and protects rights. Its basic provisions and fundamental objectives shape governance and citizenship.

End of Topic 3